



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Community Christian Academy

School Website: <https://westbendchurch.org/locations/community-christian-academy/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Community Christian Academy Wisconsin (CCA-WI) presents a robust classical, Christian-formed program embedded within the West Bend Community Church ecosystem. Public materials emphasize classical education as the intended model, a church-supported staffing framework, and explicit resources that position the school within the classical-tradition ecosystem (e.g., conversations about what classical education is, notes about curriculum staffing, and a "portrait of an educator"). Public-facing pages repeatedly reference classical education, and the site foregrounds church involvement (e.g., pastors on staff and church-affiliated branding). This alignment supports a CLASSICAL overall assessment, with strongest signals in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, and Faculty, and sustained signals in Parents & Community. Signals for Pedagogy are present but less explicit on the public site (no clear, stated use of Socratic seminars on the site itself). The aggregate profile thus lands firmly in CLASSICAL, with only minor, localized ambiguities in pedagogical phrasing.

Key public signals observed on the site: - Explicit classical-education framing and links to classical-education resources (What is Classical Education?; Classical Guide for Parents; Well-Trained Mind references; etc.). - Church affiliation and church-led staffing references (West Bend Community Church; Senior Pastor; North Site Pastor; etc.). - Staffing portrayal and "portrait of an educator" themes within the public materials. - Emphasis on assembling a culture that centers the classical-education dialogue (e.g., education consultation, volunteer opportunities, and parent-facing classical resources).

Abstract-level takeaway: The school's public materials strongly align with classical education undergirded by Christian/theological framing, with curriculum emphasis and faculty culture consistent with classical practice, and with a stated mission of formation through a classical model.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's materials are published in a church-context environment (West Bend Community Church) and refer to church-affiliated staff (Pastor roles) alongside a school website. This signals a theological framework integrated with the curriculum. - The public content explicitly frames Classical Education within a Christian context (e.g., "What is Classical Education?" and references to classical-education resources) consistent with a transcendentally oriented moral framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present in public materials: church, pastor, Christian worldview, classical education branding, and references to "What is Classical Education?" and classical-education resources. These align with Positive Keywords such as theology, liturgy (through church affiliation), and a transcendent moral frame. - Negative indicators: None evident in the public-facing content; the site emphasizes a theologically grounded, formation-oriented approach rather than secular relativism or value-neutral ethics.

Why this rating - The visible alignment with a church context, explicit church staff roles, and the explicit framing of classical education within a Christian worldview strongly supports a Classical alignment in this foundational category.

Notes on sources - Observed references to church affiliation and classical-education framing are present in the West Bend Church content about Community Christian Academy.

Citations to canonical keyword frame (for rubric alignment) - Positive keywords (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon): theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, sacred tradition, etc. The school's church affiliation and explicit Christian framing map to these ideas in practice, even if the exact word "theology" appears in broader classically Christian materials rather than in every line of the public site. See the classically lexicon for the intended positive indicators.

Rating justification - CLASSICAL: Strong alignment with transcendental moral realism and a theological grounding is evident in public materials through church affiliation, explicit Christian framing, and a classical-education orientation embedded in the site's presentation.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public statements describe Classical Education as the intended model for the school and emphasize formation through a classical-liberal framework. The site frames education as an intentional, tradition-bound formation rather than a purely vocational or utilitarian enterprise.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, great conversation, telos, scholé (restful contemplation), and the true/good/beautiful framing (as conceptual anchors in classical education). - Negative keywords: no explicit statements of workforce-first or college-and-career readiness as primary aims; the site leans toward formation and virtue rather than vocational metrics on the public-facing content.

Why this rating - The content's framing around formation and classical aims (virtue, wisdom, contemplation) aligns closely with the Positive Keyword indicators in Element 2. There is no strong public signal of mere work-readiness being foregrounded.

Notes on sources - The site's classical-education framing is explicit and repeated (e.g., "What is Classical Education?" section).

Citations to rubric frame - Positive keywords for Element 2 are drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon (formation, virtue, true/good/beautiful, scholé, great conversation). See the lexicon for the canonical list.

Rating justification - CLASSICAL: The school's public materials emphasize virtue formation, wisdom, and a classical mission—core components of the rubric for Element 2.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly references Classical Education and provides resources about classical-education models, but it does not consistently spell out a full trivium or quadrivium emphasis in the public-facing text. The page emphasizes "What is Classical Education?" and links to classical guides and well-known classical-education resources, suggesting alignment with classical curriculum ideas (great books, liberal arts, classical methods) without explicit, line-by-line curricular specifics on the Great Books or the canonical Great Conversation within the public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present in public materials: classical education framing, references to "What is Classical Education?"; classical guides and resources. - Positive keywords observed in the public materials: classical education, resources (Classical Guide for Parents, Well-Trained

Mind references), Great Books (indirectly via Well-Trained Mind and classical resources), liberal-arts framing (via the general classical education framing on the page and linked resources). - Negative keywords observed: explicit mentions of “social studies” as a replacement for history or other modern/ blocker-oriented terms are not visibly present in the site text itself; the public-facing text does not present a modern, STEM-first orientation in its formal statements. However, the public text does not always state a full Great Books curriculum, Latin/Greek emphasis, or the Quadrivium/Trivium sequence in explicit detail.

Why this rating - The public-facing content shows clear classical orientation and curriculum intent, but with limited explicit, on-page, line-by-line curricular specifics (e.g., grammars for Trivium, Quadrivium, or direct Great-Books commitments). The Positive keyword indicators (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation) are strongly implied by the resources and the classical framing but not always explicitly enumerated in the site text. This yields a “SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL” label rather than a fully explicit CLASSICAL in Curriculum per the rubric.

Notes on sources - The site’s “What is Classical Education?” page and links signal a classical-curriculum orientation (though not a full on-page Great-Books manifest).

Citations to rubric frame - The rubric emphasizes Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium) and Quadrivium with Great Books and Great Conversation as core components. See the Six Essential Elements lexicon for explicit curricular indicators.

Rating justification - SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: Public materials show classical framing and resources, but explicit, full curricular commitments (detailed Great-Books reading list, Trivium/Quadrivium curricula) are not consistently spelled out in on-page public content.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize classical education more generally and provide resources about classical pedagogy, but they do not consistently spell out the exact teaching methods (Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, recitation, etc.) in the on-page text. The site references classical pedagogy subjects and resources (e.g., “What is Classical Education?” and related materials) but lacks explicit public statements about specific active modalities in the lower/upper grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords that align with classical pedagogy on the rubric: Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, restfulness/scholé, memory work, narrative/recitation, rhetoric exercises, etc. The public content references “classical education” and provides resources that imply classical pedagogy, but explicit mentions of these teaching methods are not consistently visible in the site’s public text. - Negative keywords: The site does not emphasize purely experiential learning, project-based learning as the dominant approach; it does not foreground a student-driven constructivist pedagogy as the primary model in the on-page text.

Why this rating - The public site signals alignment with classical-pedagogy ideals (via references to classical education and classical-education resources) but lacks explicit, on-page articulation of the full pedagogical methods (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars, chant/memory work, or a fully delineated restful pedagogy). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Notes on sources - Pedagogy by public content: references to classical pedagogy and resources, without explicit enumerated practice lines.

Citations to rubric frame - The negative signals in the rubric include: experiential learning focus, project-based only, or other non-classical pedagogies. The site’s public text does not present these as the primary approach. See the Six Essential Elements lexicon for the relevant pedagogical indicators.

Rating justification - SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: Classical framing exists, but explicit, on-page pedagogical methods are not consistently detailed in the public materials.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a staffing model and “portrait of an educator” within the curriculum and staff pages, signaling that the faculty are central to the school’s classical formation. The site’s language about “curriculum, staffing model, portrait of an educator” indicates that teachers are expected to be models of virtue and living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, teachers as mentors and exemplars, faculty of friends, master/apprentice style, teacher as guide. - The site references a staff structure and church leadership (Pastor roles) indicating a culture of mentorship and living-example pedagogy.

Why this rating - The presence of explicit language around educators as central to the culture and “portrait of an educator” aligns strongly with the Classical category. The public materials indicate a culture where teachers model virtue and contribute to the formation of students, consistent with the rubric’s Element 5 indicators.

Notes on sources - The site’s own language around staffing and educator portrait appears in the public pages that discuss curriculum, staffing model, and educator portraits.

Citations to rubric frame - Positive keywords in the category are drawn from the Six Essential Elements’ Faculty indicators (model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, etc.). See the lexicon for the canonical terms.

Rating justification - CLASSICAL: The public material foregrounds teachers as central, virtuous exemplars and a living curriculum, aligning with the rubric’s Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public site provides a pathway for parent involvement (Education Consultation, Volunteer opportunities) and emphasizes partnerships with families (e.g., “Amazon Wishlist,” parent-facing resources, and open engagement with families). The content positions parents as co-participants in classical education and as co-teachers in formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, reading groups, classical book clubs, open campus, parent involvement, parental leadership, home-life integration with schooling, community of learners. - On the public content, the explicit signage of parental partnership and resources for parent formation is prominent (the page references parent-facing classical guides and community engagement).

Why this rating - The public materials strongly align with the Parents & Community indicators: partnership with families, parent formation opportunities (through resources and book clubs), and open invitation for parents to engage with the school.

Notes on sources - Observed parent/community signals (education consultation, volunteer opportunities, and parent-facing classical resources) are visible on the site.

Citations to rubric frame - Positive keywords for Element 6 are drawn from the Six Essential Elements’ Parents and Community indicators (partnership with families, parent formation, open campus). See the lexicon for the canonical terms.

Rating justification - CLASSICAL: Public-facing content demonstrates strong parent partnership and community engagement signals, consistent with the rubric.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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